DigiPick of the month

CYBER DHABA

This month's winner is
Chayan Vinayak Goswami
Bikaner
Rajasthan

He wins **Professional Java Programming** by Brett Spell
Published by Shroff Publishers and Distributors Pvt Ltd., Bandra (W), Mumbai

WIN!
Send in your entry and you could win an exciting gift just by sharing an amusing picture with a tech angle to it. The picture should be shot by you, and should not have been published anywhere earlier. E-mail your picture with the subject **'DigiPick'** and your postal address **on or before 15th of this month** to **digipick@thinkdigit.com.** One prize-winning picture will be published each month.

has analysed the Mona Lisa and found that she was "83 percent happy, 9 percent disgusted, 6 percent fearful, and 2 percent angry."

This result was obtained by Dr Nicu Sebe, a professor at the University of Amsterdam. Sebe used an emotion recognition software that was developed under professor Thomas Huang of the Image Formation and Processing Faculty at the University of Illonois at Urbana-Champaign.

The software was originally developed to recognise expressions of a human user interacting with a computer—better known as Human Computer Interaction (HCI). Sebe used a computer to create a 3D digital image of the Mona Lisa, and then compared it to his database of pictures of women in different emotional states.

The software looks at the eyes and lips, the curvature of the smile, and many other aspects of an image to arrive at a percentage for six emotions—anger, disgust, fear, happiness, sadness and surprise.

According to the computer's findings, Mona Lisa has no surprise or sadness registered on her face—which seems logical; since she was posing for a portrait, surprise is not an option, and since she was smiling, we could rule out sadness as well!

What's more interesting than using the software to figure what people were thinking in old portraits is to use it on digital images of today.

Since men are often confused about what women are "really" thinking, and vice versa, reading someone's mind could be as easy as snapping away with your digital camera.

There's also talk of using the software to run real-time scans at airports and other high security areas to analyse what people are really thinking.

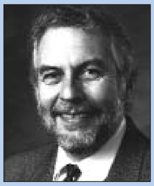
This way, even if you were nervous or scared, but smiling (as terrorists might do at check-in), you could fool the human staff, but the computer wouldn't let you off the hook that easily!

Of course, this technology can be extended to read other signs such as body language. So the next time you walk into a corporate office for an interview, look around for cameras—they could be informing your would-be employers about what you're thinking and even your current emotional state. All this without meeting you face to face!

People Who Changed Computing

Gaming Pioneer

Nolan Bushnell is widely considered the father of electronic gaming. Bushnell had an eventful childhood—he nearly burnt down his family's garage with a homemade liquid-fuel rocket mounted on a roller skate! At age 15, when his father died, he took over their concrete business.


Nolan Bushnell

Bushnell attended the University of Utah where he studied computer graphics, managed an amusement park and also played tournament chess on the side. Bushnell believed that computer games were a means of education as they fostered curiosity and creativity in individuals. He went on to invent his first computerised video game, *Computer Space*, in 1970.

In 1972, Bushnell along with his business partner Ted Dabney founded Atari Corporation. The same year, Bushnell invented *Pong*, a video version of ping-pong. *Pong* was the first commercially successful video game and is believed to have started the video game era. In 1975, Bushnell made an agreement with Sears to sell a home video game version of *Pong*.

In 1976, he sold Atari to Time Warner for $28 million (Rs 26 crore back then). In 1977, he also started another company, Chuck E. Cheese pizza restaurants, where kids could eat and also play electronic games.

Bushnell has founded 20 companies till date. He now envisions Internet-based games that can accommodate thousands of persons per team. He also lectures in the US, motivating others with his views on entrepreneurship and innovation.